



AFRICAN CONNECTIONS

"Your Gateway to Africa"

Welcomes You to Kenya



Karibu (Welcome in Swahili)

Thank you for choosing African Connections to provide comprehensive tour services for your upcoming “Kenya, Tanzania, Zanzibar Tour” scheduled for August 14th - 24th 2026 (10 nights/11 days).

African Connections, “AC” is your Gateway to Africa. We have been a leader in African travel for over 20 years and the entire AC Team is preparing for your upcoming visit to Kenya and Tanzania.

We pride ourselves on delivery of outstanding concierge services and we are happy to assist you and provide you with information you’ll need to prepare for your journey.

When you reach Kenya and Tanzania, we will meet you at the airport when you arrive and assist you throughout your stay in Kenya and Tanzania.

Our team is knowledgeable and professional and proud to show you the wonders of Kenya and Tanzania, countries we know so well.

This welcome guide will provide you with information that will be helpful as you make your travel preparations.

Please review this information carefully. We welcome your questions and look forward to seeing you in Kenya and Tanzania soon!

Your Tour

You should book your tickets so that you depart from the USA on August 13th 2026, with your arrival in Kenya on August 14th 2026.

Your tickets should have you depart from Tanzania on August 24th 2026, and arrive back in the United States on August 25th 2026.

Your tour begins when you arrive in Kenya on August 14th and ends when we see you off at the airport on August 24th 2026.

Kenya Travel Requirements

Kenya is a tourist friendly destination, but it is important that you are aware of travel requirements and have your travel documents ready well in advance of your departure date. Please read the following information carefully.

Passports and Visas

A valid passport is required for all international travel.

U.S. citizens need a visa to enter Kenya for stays of up to 90 days. However, **all visitors are required to obtain an [electronic travel authorization \(eTA\)](#) before entering Kenya**. Also, there are other requirements to meet, including:

Passport: A valid U.S. passport with at least one blank visa page

Proof of travel: Proof of return or onward flights

Proof of funds: Proof of sufficient funds for the duration of your stay

Proof of purpose: Documents showing the purpose of your trip

ETA Fee: \$74

Your passport must be valid for at least six months from the date of your arrival back in the United States. Check your passport expiration date to be sure it meets this requirement and if necessary, apply for a renewal as soon as possible. You will not be allowed to board your departure flight if your passport expiration date is within six months of your scheduled return to your home country.

Immunization and Medical Information

Yellow Fever Vaccination:

Yellow fever vaccination is not required of US citizens who have not been in an infested area.

If you get the Yellow Fever vaccine, be sure this is indicated in your yellow International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis (ICVP). **It is your responsibility to comply with all immunization requirements.**

Malaria Prevention and other Immunizations:

Your doctor might also recommend other vaccinations which are not mandatory for travel to Togo. It is up to you to decide if you take any or all such recommended vaccinations as they are not required for entry into Kenya.

While it is not mandatory, we strongly recommend that you acquire anti-malarial medication. Malaria is a serious potential (but treatable) health threat, and you should take necessary precautions to minimize your risk.

It is also a good idea to bring your favorite mosquito repellant to further protect yourself from the mosquitos that you might encounter.

Prescription Medications:

If you take prescription medication, you are responsible for determining their legality in Kenya and note the following:

- We advise you to bring enough of your medication with you.
- Always keep your medication in the original container.
- Carry a copy of your prescription(s).
- Pack your medicine in your carry-on luggage, not your checked luggage.

Travel Insurance

Travel Insurance is not included in your package. However, it is strongly recommended that you purchase travel insurance to cover any unexpected event that might interrupt or prevent your travel.

Our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click on the link below or go to our website www.africanconnections-usa.com to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHSDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWBJM3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMNXVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

Shopping in Kenya

You'll love shopping in Kenya! From the bustling markets of Nairobi to the vibrant coastal towns of Mombasa and Malindi, Kenya offers an exciting and authentic shopping experience rich in tradition and craftsmanship. Discover the vivid colors and patterns of kikoy and kitenge fabrics, the intricate beauty of Maasai beadwork, hand-carved soapstone sculptures from Kisii, and the bold designs of batik art and wood carvings. Each item reflects Kenya's diverse cultures and heritage. Whether you're exploring Maasai Market in Nairobi or browsing artisan cooperatives in rural villages, you'll find a wide variety of handmade treasures and unique souvenirs that capture the spirit and artistry of this remarkable country.

Clothing and Packing

Bring comfortable, breathable clothing for your trip to Kenya. Lightweight fabrics like cotton and linen are ideal for the warm, often sunny climate, especially if you'll be spending time along the coast in places like Mombasa or Diani Beach. Pack a light sweater or jacket for the cooler mornings and evenings in the highlands and safari destinations such as Nairobi, the Maasai Mara, or Mount Kenya. Comfortable walking shoes or sandals are a must, especially if you plan to explore markets, towns, or go on outdoor adventures.

Note: Kenya is a culturally respectful country with rich traditions and religious diversity. In many areas—especially rural villages, religious sites, and coastal towns like Lamu—modest dress is both expected and appreciated. Women should consider wearing skirts or pants that cover the knees and tops that cover the shoulders. Men are also encouraged to dress conservatively in these settings. For beach resorts, don't forget your swimsuit, a cover-up, and flip-flops. A wide-brimmed hat, sunglasses, and sunscreen will also help protect you from the strong equatorial sun.

Don't bring electrical appliances and gadgets. The electric outlets in Kenya are 240 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. **This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Kenya.** The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Kenya. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Kenya are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

You can bring your own adapter or buy one when you arrive as adapters are very inexpensive in Benin and are readily available.

Toiletries/Personal Items

Be sure you bring all your toiletries and personal items. While you will have opportunities to buy such things in Kenya, you might not be able to find the brands you prefer.

Customs Requirements

Passengers' obligations at Kenyan Customs are outlined on the Kenya Revenue Authority (KRA) website. For full details, please visit <https://www.kra.go.ke>.

When you arrive in Kenya you will pass through Kenya Customs, and you might be asked if you have anything to declare. You must declare any commercial goods or currency more than \$10,000 that you bring into Kenya.

Money/Credit and Debit Cards/ATM's:

Cash

There is no limit on the amount of money you can bring into Kenya. However, as stated above, if you bring in more than \$10,000 in cash, you must declare it when you pass through customs on entry. If you bring in less than \$10,000, there is no need to declare any cash that you bring in. You will have several opportunities to change your dollars for the local currency during your stay in Kenya. Please note that it is advisable that you bring any cash that you bring in either \$100 or \$50 bills as smaller denominations will be exchanged for a significantly lower exchange rate.

ATMs

There are ATMs in all the major cities you visit, but you will pay an international fee and a local bank fee for ATM transactions in addition to possibly receiving a lower exchange rate for each transaction.

Credit and Debit Cards

There will be several places where you can use your credit or debit card in Kenya, particularly in major hotels, upscale restaurants, and larger shops or supermarkets in cities like Nairobi, Mombasa, and Kisumu. However, Kenya remains largely a cash-based economy in rural areas, local markets, and smaller businesses. It's a good idea to carry enough Kenyan shillings for everyday purchases and tipping. If you plan to use your debit or credit card while traveling, be sure to notify your bank in advance that you'll be in Kenya to avoid any security holds or transaction blocks on your account.

Also, note, many of the businesses that take debit or credit cards use POS equipment which requires a pin number. While we all know our debit card pin number, most of us do not have or know a pin number for our credit cards. So, if you intend to use a credit card, contact your bank, and make sure you have and know the pin number associated with the card.

Note: the only credit cards accepted in Kenya are Visa and Mastercard.

Food and Water

Your tour package includes breakfast daily and other specified meals (lunch/dinner), including a Welcome Dinner with Cultural Performances.

You will be able to buy meals that are not included in the tour package at restaurants that we have carefully selected. There will be a wide variety of food options available, giving you the chance to enjoy delicious Kenyan cuisine, while also having access to more familiar international dishes. From flavorful nyama choma (grilled meat) and sukuma wiki (collard greens) to fresh seafood on the coast and tropical fruits, there's something to suit every palate. The average cost of a meal with a soft drink and water in Kenya ranges from \$10–\$20, depending on the location and type of restaurant.

Bottled water is readily available. However, the water in all of the hotels and restaurants that have been selected for you is potable and is safe for you to drink, use as ice cubes or to brush your teeth.

While some of your favorite snacks might be available in Kenya, and we will make regular stops for you to stock up on snacks, fruit, and drinks during the trip, it is advisable for you to bring the special snacks that you prefer.

Hotels and Restaurants in Kenya:

Hotels

You will be staying at hotels that have been carefully selected for you to ensure your comfort. These hotels are highly rated with clean comfortable rooms and well-trained staff. However, standards might vary from those to which you might be accustomed.

For example, while bath towels and hand towels are available and supplied at all the selected hotels, face cloths are not normally available. So, you should bring your own face cloth.

Rest assured; our ground staff will be available to address any issue that might arise.

Restaurants

We have carefully selected each of the restaurants you will visit on your tour. These restaurants are chosen for their quality, cleanliness, and welcoming atmosphere, offering you a chance to enjoy safe, wholesome meals throughout your stay. You'll have the option to try authentic Kenyan dishes or choose from a variety of continental options that may be more familiar to your taste.

While the food is tasty, Kenyan restaurants are known for slow service, so you might have to exercise a bit of patience before your meal arrives. Whenever possible, our staff will help you to place your order in advance of arrival at a restaurant, to cut down on the wait time.

Cell Phone/Data Usage and Internet Service:

Before your departure to Kenya contact your mobile phone service provider and request international data service to access WhatsApp, or similar apps for internet-based communications. Such communications are significantly less costly than international roaming charges.

You could also ask for a one-month international voice package. While this could be costly, it is cheaper than the bill you will receive if you make calls without a call package.

If you make or receive international calls while you are in Kenya and you do not have the appropriate international call/data packages, you will be shocked when you receive your telephone service billing statement.

Other information that might be helpful as you prepare for your trip:

Country Profile

Kenya is located in East Africa, bordered by Ethiopia to the north, Somalia to the east, Tanzania to the south, Uganda to the west, and South Sudan to the northwest, with the Indian Ocean along its southeastern coast. The country's diverse geography includes sweeping savannahs, the Great Rift Valley, highlands, semi-arid regions, and beautiful beaches along the coast. Kenya is also home to Mount Kenya, Africa's second-highest peak, and part of Lake Victoria, the continent's largest lake. The climate is generally tropical along the coast and arid in the north and northeast, while the highland areas enjoy a cooler, temperate climate. Kenya experiences two rainy seasons: the long rains from March to May and the short rains from October to December.

The capital city is Nairobi, a major economic and cultural hub in the region. Other important cities include Mombasa, Kenya's main port city on the coast; Kisumu on Lake Victoria; and Nakuru in the Rift Valley. Kenya has a population of over 55 million people, comprising more than 40 ethnic groups. The largest include the Kikuyu, Luhya, Luo, Kalenjin, and Kamba. Swahili (Kiswahili) and English are both official languages and widely spoken, especially in business, government, and education. Kenya is religiously diverse, with Christianity and Islam as the major faiths, alongside traditional African beliefs practiced in some communities.

Kenya's rich history includes ancient trade networks along the Indian Ocean coast, powerful kingdoms in the interior, and colonial rule under the British until gaining independence in 1963. Today, Kenya is known for its political influence in the region, world-renowned wildlife and national parks, vibrant cultural heritage, and the warmth and hospitality of its people.

Geography:

Kenya, officially the Republic of Kenya, is located in East Africa and stretches from the Indian Ocean in the southeast to the Great Rift Valley and Lake Victoria in the west. It shares borders with Ethiopia to the north, Somalia to the east, Tanzania to the south, Uganda to the west, and South Sudan to the northwest. Its coastal location along the Indian Ocean provides access to key international maritime trade routes through the major port city of Mombasa.

Covering approximately 580,367 square kilometers (224,081 sq mi), Kenya is one of the larger countries in the region. It has a population of over 55 million people and is known for its cultural richness, with more than 40 distinct ethnic groups. Kenya is a unitary presidential republic, gaining independence from British colonial rule in 1963. The country operates under a multi-party political system and has been a leading economic and diplomatic power in East Africa. Despite challenges, Kenya has maintained a strong sense of national identity and unity, making it a key player in regional stability and development.

Economy:

The economy of Kenya is diverse and dynamic, with key sectors including agriculture, services, manufacturing, tourism, and information and communications technology (ICT). Agriculture remains a cornerstone of the economy, employing a large portion of the population and contributing significantly to GDP. Major crops include tea, coffee, maize, sugarcane, horticultural products, and flowers—Kenya is one of the world's leading exporters of black tea and cut flowers.

Kenya is also rich in natural resources, with deposits of soda ash, limestone, fluorspar, and more recently, oil and natural gas discoveries. The mining and extractives sector is steadily growing. Tourism is another vital economic driver, with Kenya globally recognized for its wildlife safaris, Maasai Mara National Reserve, Great Rift Valley lakes, and pristine coastal destinations like Diani Beach and Lamu.

The country has made significant strides in infrastructure development, particularly in transport (like the Standard Gauge Railway), energy, and port facilities that support trade and economic integration in the region. Nairobi, the capital and commercial hub, is also known as the "Silicon Savannah," reflecting its leadership in mobile banking, fintech, and digital innovation across Africa. In recent years, the government has prioritized industrialization, affordable housing, universal healthcare, and technological advancement as part of its Vision 2030 development blueprint, aiming to transform Kenya into a newly industrialized middle-income country.

The Currency

The official currency of Kenya is the Kenyan Shilling, with the currency code KES. It is commonly represented as "KSh" or simply "Sh". The Kenyan Shilling is not pegged to any foreign currency and its exchange rate with the U.S. dollar may vary based on market conditions. When traveling to Kenya, you can exchange U.S. dollars for Kenyan Shillings at local banks, authorized currency exchange bureaus, or at the airport. It is advisable to carry some Kenyan Shillings for smaller transactions, as not all establishments may accept U.S. dollars, especially outside major cities. Regarding bringing cash into the country, there is no limit on the amount of Kenyan Shillings you can bring in. However, if you are carrying the equivalent of \$10,000 USD or more in any currency, you must declare it to customs upon arrival. Amounts below this threshold do not require a declaration.

Language:

The official languages of Kenya are Swahili (Kiswahili) and English, both of which play important roles in the country's governance, education, and business sectors. Swahili is the national language and is widely spoken across Kenya, serving as a key medium of communication among the country's many ethnic groups. English, introduced during the colonial era, is commonly used in formal settings, such as government offices, the legal system, and higher education institutions. Kenya is one of the most linguistically diverse countries in Africa, home to over 40 ethnic groups, each with its own language or dialect. Some of the most widely spoken indigenous languages include Kikuyu, Luhya, Luo, Kamba, Kalenjin, and Maasai. These languages are predominantly spoken in their respective regions and are often used in homes and local communities. While Swahili is spoken across the country and taught in schools, its use tends to vary by region and context. In urban areas like Nairobi, Mombasa, and Kisumu, both English and Swahili are commonly spoken, and many people are bilingual or trilingual. In rural areas, local ethnic languages are more dominant in daily life, though most people still understand and speak Swahili to some degree. For visitors, communication is generally easy, especially in cities and tourist destinations, where English is widely understood, particularly in the hospitality and service sectors. However, learning a few basic Swahili phrases can greatly enhance your interactions and is often warmly received by locals.

Government:

Kenya is a republic with a presidential system of government, where the President serves as both the head of state and head of government. The President is elected by popular vote for a five-year term and may serve a maximum of two terms. Kenya practices a multi-party democratic system, with elections held regularly under the oversight of the Independent Electoral and Boundaries Commission (IEBC). The current constitutional framework is based on the 2010 Constitution, which marked a major shift in Kenya's governance by promoting devolution, enhancing checks and balances, and guaranteeing more rights and freedoms. Kenya's government is divided into three branches:

- Executive: Led by the President, who appoints Cabinet Secretaries (ministers) and leads the national government.
- Legislative: Consists of a bicameral Parliament—the National Assembly and the Senate—which is responsible for lawmaking, budget approval, and oversight of the executive.
- Judiciary: Independent from the other branches, it is headed by the Chief Justice and includes various courts, with the Supreme Court being the highest authority on constitutional matters.

Kenya is also divided into 47 counties, each with its own local government and governor, as part of the devolved system intended to bring services closer to citizens and promote regional development. Kenya has held regular, competitive elections, though they have occasionally been marred by controversies and political tensions, most notably in 2007. Despite challenges, the country continues to strengthen its democratic institutions and electoral processes.

Current President: William Samoei Ruto

Vice President: Kithure Kindiki

History:

Before European colonization, Kenya was home to a wide range of ethnic groups and communities, each with its own systems of governance, culture, and trade. Notable among these were the Kikuyu, Luo, Luhya, Kamba, Maasai, and Mijikenda, among others. The coastal regions of Kenya were particularly active in long-distance trade across the Indian Ocean, engaging with Arab, Persian, and Indian traders. Important city-states like Mombasa, Malindi, and Lamu became key hubs in the Swahili Coast trading network, dealing in goods such as ivory, gold, slaves, and spices.

The Portuguese were the first Europeans to arrive on the Kenyan coast in the late 15th century, establishing a presence in cities like Mombasa, where they built Fort Jesus in 1593. However, their control was challenged and eventually supplanted by Omani Arabs in the 17th century, who established influence over the coastal strip and integrated it into the Sultanate of Zanzibar.

In the late 19th century, Kenya came under British colonial control. The British declared the area a protectorate in 1895 and later a colony in 1920. Colonial rule introduced new administrative structures, land policies that displaced many indigenous communities (especially in the so-called “White Highlands”), and infrastructure such as the Uganda Railway. African resistance to colonialism grew over the years, culminating in the Mau Mau Uprising (1952–1960)—a major rebellion led primarily by the Kikuyu people against British rule and land injustices.

Kenya achieved independence from Britain on December 12, 1963, with Jomo Kenyatta becoming the country’s first Prime Minister and, later, its first President. Post-independence, Kenya was initially a de facto one-party state, especially under Daniel arap Moi, who succeeded Kenyatta. In

the early 1990s, internal pressure and international influence led to the reintroduction of a multi-party political system. Since then, Kenya has held regular elections and experienced both political challenges and peaceful transitions of power. The 2007–2008 post-election violence was a significant moment in the country's recent history, prompting wide-ranging constitutional and institutional reforms. The adoption of a new constitution in 2010 introduced a devolved system of governance and expanded civil rights. Today, Kenya is one of the most influential and dynamic countries in East Africa, with a growing economy, active civil society, and a significant role in regional diplomacy and international affairs. Despite ongoing issues related to corruption, inequality, and ethnic tensions, Kenya remains a key political and economic player on the African continent.

Climate:

Kenya has a diverse tropical climate that varies significantly by region, elevation, and proximity to large water bodies like Lake Victoria and the Indian Ocean. Along the coast, including cities like Mombasa and Malindi, the climate is typically hot and humid year-round. In contrast, inland areas such as Nairobi and the Central Highlands experience a more temperate climate, with cooler temperatures due to higher elevations. The northern and northeastern regions of the country, bordering Somalia and Ethiopia, are generally hot and arid, while the western region near Lake Victoria tends to be wetter and more humid.

Average daily temperatures across Kenya typically range from 70°F to 90°F (21°C to 32°C) depending on the location and season. Nairobi, for example, sits at about 5,500 feet (1,680 meters) above sea level and enjoys mild temperatures year-round, with average highs around 75°F (24°C). Kenya has two main rainy seasons: the long rains from March to May and the short rains from October to December. The dry seasons run from June to September and January to February, with July and August being among the driest and coolest months, particularly in the highland areas.

In August, Kenya is well into its dry season. This is generally considered one of the best times to visit the country. The weather is mostly sunny, dry, and mild, especially in areas like Nairobi and the Great Rift Valley. Coastal regions remain warm and humid, with daytime temperatures averaging between 79°F and 86°F (26°C to 30°C), while the highlands can be cooler, particularly at night, with temperatures dropping to around 55°F (13°C). Rainfall is minimal during this time, making it ideal for wildlife safaris, beach holidays, and mountain climbing, particularly on Mount Kenya.

Frequently Asked Questions

General Travel Information

1. Do I need a visa to visit Kenya?

Yes, U.S. citizens need visa to enter Kenya. However, US citizens need Electronic Travel Authorization (ETA) in order to acquire their visa. You can obtain an Electronic Travel Authorization (ETA) online before arrival. Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your travel dates.

2. How can I apply for a ETA?

You can apply for Electronic Travel Authorization (ETA) online via the Kenya eTA Application Form online with a fee of \$74. Check our website for the latest visa information and application links.

3. What vaccinations do I need before traveling?

A Yellow Fever vaccination is required for entry into Kenya. Other recommended vaccines include Hepatitis A & B, typhoid, tetanus, and malaria prophylaxis.

4. Is Kenya safe for tourists?

Kenya is generally considered safe for travelers, especially in popular tourist destinations such as Nairobi, Mombasa, the Maasai Mara, Lake Naivasha, and national parks. However, as with travel to any country, it's important to stay vigilant and take common-sense precautions. Petty crime—including pickpocketing, bag snatching, and phone theft—can occur, particularly in crowded urban areas like Nairobi and Mombasa, and in busy spots such as markets, public transport hubs, and city centers. Travelers are advised to avoid walking alone at night, especially in poorly lit or unfamiliar neighborhoods. It's also wise to limit the amount of cash or valuables you carry, and to store important documents, like passports, in a hotel safe whenever possible. Registered taxis or reputable ride-hailing apps (like Uber and Bolt, which are available in major cities) are safer options than informal public transport, particularly after dark. Tourist areas and rural regions, including national parks and game reserves, are generally safe and well-patrolled, with local communities often being friendly and welcoming. However, travelers should always listen to local guidance, follow park rules during safaris, and avoid venturing into isolated areas without a guide. While most visits to Kenya are trouble-free, it's important to monitor local travel advisories—especially in areas near the borders with Somalia, South Sudan, and Ethiopia, where security conditions can be more volatile. As in any travel setting, showing respect for local customs and culture, maintaining situational awareness, and staying informed about current conditions will help ensure a safe and rewarding experience in Kenya.

5. What is the best time to visit Kenya?

August is a great time to visit Kenya, offering mostly sunny, dry, and comfortable weather across much of the country. It falls during Kenya's cool, dry season, making it one of the most popular months for safaris and outdoor adventures. Along the coast, including destinations like Mombasa, Diani Beach, and Malindi, the weather remains warm and humid, with average daytime temperatures ranging from 79°F to 86°F (26°C to 30°C). Ocean conditions are generally calm, making this a good time for beach holidays and water activities.

In the inland and highland areas, including Nairobi, the Maasai Mara, and Mount Kenya, temperatures are milder and cooler, especially at night. Daytime highs typically range from 68°F to 77°F (20°C to 25°C), while night temperatures can dip to around 50°F (10°C). Skies are generally clear, and rainfall is minimal, which provides excellent visibility for wildlife viewing during the Great Migration in the Maasai Mara. August's combination of comfortable temperatures, low humidity, and dry weather makes it one of the best months to experience Kenya's national parks, mountain trails, and coastline.

6. What is the dress code in Kenya?

Bring comfortable, breathable clothing for your trip to Kenya. Lightweight fabrics such as cotton and linen are ideal for the generally warm and sunny climate, particularly if you'll be spending time along the coast or in lowland areas like Mombasa or the Great Rift Valley. For the highland regions, including Nairobi, Mount Kenya, and the Maasai Mara, it's wise to pack a light sweater or jacket for the cooler mornings and evenings, especially during the dry season (like in August), when temperatures can drop at night. If you're going on safari, consider neutral-colored clothing to blend into the environment and reduce heat absorption. Also, a wide-brimmed hat, sunglasses, and sunscreen are recommended for sun protection during outdoor activities.

7. Are public toilets available at tourist sites?

Public toilets are available at major tourist attractions, but they may not always be well-maintained. Carry tissues and hand sanitizer.

8. Is there internet access?

Hotels, cafes, and restaurants in major cities offer Wi-Fi. A local SIM card is recommended for better mobile internet access.

9. Is it allowed to take photographs of people?

Always ask for permission before photographing individuals, especially in rural areas and markets.

10. What fitness level is required for sightseeing?

A moderate fitness level is recommended, especially for excursions to natural sites and islands.

11. What kind of shoes should I wear?

Comfortable walking shoes or sandals are essential for your trip to Kenya, especially if you plan to explore local markets, towns, or take part in outdoor excursions and safaris. Closed-toe shoes with good support are recommended for activities like walking tours, nature hikes, or visits to national parks, while breathable sandals are ideal for casual strolls in warm, urban or coastal areas. On safari visit, consider sturdy, lightweight hiking shoes or trainers that can handle uneven terrain and offer protection from dust and insects.

12. How is the power supply in Kenya?

The electric outlets in Kenya supply 240 volts at a frequency of 50 Hz, which is significantly higher than the 110 volts used in the United States. If you're traveling from the U.S. or another country with a different voltage standard, be aware that most appliances that are not dual voltage will require a voltage converter to operate safely in Kenya. However, many modern electronic devices—such as smartphones, laptops, cameras, and tablets—are typically dual voltage (100–240V) and should work fine. Always check the voltage label on your device before plugging it in. Kenya uses Type G plugs, the same as those used in the United Kingdom. These have three rectangular prongs. If your device's plug is different, you'll need a plug adapter. It's recommended to bring a universal travel adapter if you plan to use multiple devices or travel to other countries in the region. A small power strip with surge protection can also be helpful if you're charging several devices at once.

13. Can I drink alcohol in Kenya?

Yes, alcohol is widely available in Kenya, and it is commonly served in hotels, restaurants, bars, and clubs across the country, especially in urban centers like Nairobi, Mombasa, Kisumu, and popular tourist destinations such as the Maasai Mara and the coastline. Kenya has a diverse cultural and religious makeup, with Christianity being the predominant religion, and alcohol is generally socially accepted in most parts of the country.

However, in areas with a significant Muslim population, such as parts of the coastal region including Mombasa and Lamu, alcohol may be less prominently available, and public consumption is often more discreet out of respect for local customs and religious beliefs. That said, many hotels, lodges, and beach resorts in these areas still serve alcohol to guests. As with any destination, visitors are encouraged to drink responsibly and be mindful of cultural norms, especially during religious holidays like Ramadan. Being respectful of the local environment and people will help ensure a smooth and enjoyable experience.

14. Is smoking allowed in Kenya?

Smoking is permitted in outdoor areas in Kenya, but it is strictly prohibited in enclosed public spaces, including restaurants, bars, offices, airports, and public transport. Kenya has clear anti-smoking regulations in place to protect public health, and designated smoking zones are often provided in larger establishments such as hotels, shopping malls, and airports.

Smokers should be aware that violating smoking restrictions in public spaces can result in fines or other penalties. It's advisable to look for posted signs or ask staff before lighting up, especially in urban areas and formal settings. As always, being considerate of non-smokers and local regulations will help ensure a respectful and hassle-free experience.

15. What food options are available in Kenya?

In hotels throughout Kenya, a full buffet breakfast is commonly offered each day, typically featuring a mix of continental items and local favorites. Kenyan cuisine is diverse, flavorful, and influenced by African, Arab, Indian, and European culinary traditions, reflecting the country's multicultural heritage and regional diversity. Traditional Kenyan meals often include staples such as ugali (a stiff maize porridge), rice, chapati (Indian-style flatbread), and matoke (stewed green bananas), usually served with vegetable stews, legumes, or grilled meats. Nyama choma (grilled meat—usually goat, beef, or chicken) is a beloved national dish and is often enjoyed with sides like kachumbari, a tangy tomato and onion salad.

Coastal regions, particularly around Mombasa, feature a distinct Swahili cuisine that incorporates coconut milk, aromatic spices, and seafood such as fish, prawns, and octopus. Dishes like pilau (spiced rice) and biryani are common in these areas. Vegetarian dishes are widely available, especially in Indian-influenced eateries and among traditional Kenyan fare. Common options include sukuma wiki (collard greens), ndengu (green grams), lentils, and other vegetables stewed in savory sauces. Meals are often accompanied by fresh tropical fruits like mangoes, pineapples, papayas, and bananas, along with fresh juices, chai (spiced tea), or locally brewed coffee, especially from regions like Mount Kenya and Kisii.

Money & Costs

16. What currency is used in Kenya?

The official currency of Kenya is the Kenyan Shilling (KES). Credit and debit cards are widely accepted in major hotels, upscale restaurants, shopping malls, and larger businesses, especially in urban areas like Nairobi, Mombasa, Kisumu, and popular tourist

destinations. However, cash remains the preferred method of payment in local markets, small shops, and rural areas, where card payment facilities may be limited or unavailable.

It's advisable to carry some Kenyan Shillings for everyday purchases, tipping, or transportation, especially when venturing outside the cities. ATMs are widely available in towns and cities, and most accept international cards for cash withdrawals. Kenya also has a highly developed mobile money system, especially M-Pesa, which is commonly used for paying bills, transportation, and even shopping in many places. When using cards, be mindful of potential surcharges and always inform your bank of your travel plans to avoid any issues with card use.

17. How much does a meal cost in Kenya?

A meal at a mid-range restaurant costs about \$15-\$25, while street food or casual dining can be around \$5-\$10.

18. Can I use U.S. dollars in Kenya?

U.S. dollars are not widely accepted. It is best to exchange money at banks or Forex Bureaus.

Transportation & Getting Around

19. Do I need an international driver's license to rent a car?

Yes, an International Driving Permit (IDP) is required to rent a car. Traffic conditions can be hectic, so hiring a driver is recommended.

20. Is public transportation safe?

Public transportation, such as minibuses and shared taxis, can be crowded and confusing. Tourists are advised to use private taxis or ride-hailing services.

Health & Safety

21. Is tap water safe to drink?

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels

and the restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So, you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

22. Do I need travel insurance?

Yes, travel insurance is highly recommended for medical emergencies, lost luggage, and trip cancellations.

However, our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

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23. Should I bring my own medicine?

Bring sufficient prescribed medication for your trip. Pharmacies are available, but specific medicines may not always be in stock.

Activities

24. Is there time for shopping?

Kenya is renowned for its lively and colorful markets, where visitors can shop for an array of traditional crafts and locally made products that reflect the country's rich cultural heritage. Popular items include vibrant kikoy and kitenge fabrics, hand-beaded Maasai jewelry, carved soapstone sculptures from Kisii, wooden carvings, woven sisal baskets (kiondo), and batik or tie-dye textiles. Kenyan coffee and tea, along with local spices and handmade beauty products, are also favorite take-home items.

Some of the best-known markets include Maasai Market (held on different days in various parts of Nairobi), City Market in downtown Nairobi, Gikomba Market for bargain hunters, and Mombasa's Old Town markets, which showcase a Swahili-Arab influence. These markets provide a genuine cultural experience, and visitors are encouraged to bargain respectfully, as haggling is a normal and expected part of the shopping process. Exploring

Kenya's markets offers not only the chance to find unique souvenirs, but also an opportunity to interact with local artisans and support small-scale producers and traditional craftspeople.

25. Can I make personal purchases?

Yes, budget around \$8-\$25 per day for personal expenses like snacks, drinks, and souvenirs. Larger purchases can be made with credit cards in major stores.

Prepare to be Amazed!

Beneath the timeless landscapes of modern Ethiopia lies a land where ancient civilizations, sacred traditions, and vibrant cultures meet. From the majestic Simien Mountains to the rock-hewn churches of Lalibela, Ethiopia is a country of wonder, history, and spiritual depth. Ethiopia is unique and unforgettable. Have your cameras ready!

The African Connections Team is eagerly awaiting your arrival in Ethiopia and is ready to assist you as you prepare for your extraordinary African adventure!

Tanzania Travel Requirements

Tanzania is a tourist friendly destination, but it is important that you are aware of travel requirements and have your travel documents ready well in advance of your departure date. Please read the following information carefully.

Passports and Visas

A valid passport is required for all international travel.

U.S. citizens need a visa to enter Tanzania for stays of up to 12 months. However, there are other requirements to meet, including:

Passport: A valid U.S. passport with at least one blank visa page

Proof of travel: Proof of return or onward flights

Proof of funds: Proof of sufficient funds for the duration of your stay

Proof of purpose: Documents showing the purpose of your trip

Visa Fee: \$100

Your passport must be valid for at least six months from the date of your arrival back in the United States. Check your passport expiration date to be sure it meets this requirement and if necessary, apply for a renewal as soon as possible. You will not be allowed to board your departure flight if your passport expiration date is within six months of your scheduled return to your home country.

Immunization and Medical Information

Yellow Fever Vaccination:

Yellow fever vaccination is not required of US citizens who have not been in an infested area.

If you get the Yellow Fever vaccine, be sure this is indicated in your yellow International Certificate of Vaccination or Prophylaxis (ICVP). **It is your responsibility to comply with all immunization requirements.**

Malaria Prevention and other Immunizations:

Your doctor might also recommend other vaccinations which are not mandatory for travel to Togo. It is up to you to decide if you take any or all such recommended vaccinations as they are not required for entry into Tanzania.

While it is not mandatory, we strongly recommend that you acquire anti-malarial medication. Malaria is a serious potential (but treatable) health threat, and you should take necessary precautions to minimize your risk.

It is also a good idea to bring your favorite mosquito repellent to further protect yourself from the mosquitos that you might encounter.

Prescription Medications:

If you take prescription medication, you are responsible for determining their legality in Tanzania and note the following:

- We advise you to bring enough of your medication with you.
- Always keep your medication in the original container.
- Carry a copy of your prescription(s).
- Pack your medicine in your carry-on luggage, not your checked luggage.

Travel Insurance

Travel Insurance is not included in your package. However, it is strongly recommended that you purchase travel insurance to cover any unexpected event that might interrupt or prevent your travel.

Our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click on the link below or go to our website www.africanconnections-usa.com to get a quote.

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Shopping in Tanzania

You'll love shopping in Tanzania! From the lively markets of Dar es Salaam to the cultural hubs of Arusha, Zanzibar, and Moshi, Tanzania offers a dynamic and authentic shopping experience steeped in tradition and artistry. Discover the bold colors and patterns of kitenge and khangas fabrics, the delicate beauty of Maasai beadwork, hand-carved ebony sculptures, and intricate Tingatinga paintings—each item tells a story of Tanzanian culture and heritage. Whether you're browsing seaside stalls in Stone Town or exploring craft cooperatives in rural villages, you'll find a rich variety of handmade goods and unique souvenirs that reflect the heart and soul of this incredible country.

Clothing and Packing

Bring comfortable, breathable clothing for your trip to Tanzania. Lightweight fabrics like cotton and linen are ideal for the warm, often humid climate, especially if you'll be spending time along the coast or in lowland areas. Pack a light sweater or jacket for the cooler highland mornings and evenings, particularly if you're visiting places like Arusha or the Ngorongoro Highlands. Comfortable walking shoes or sandals are a must, especially if you plan to explore markets, towns, or take part in outdoor excursions.

Note: Tanzania is a culturally respectful country with deep traditions and religious diversity. In many areas—especially rural villages, religious sites, or Zanzibar—modest dress is both expected and appreciated. Women should consider wearing skirts or pants that cover the knees and tops that cover the shoulders. Men are also encouraged to dress conservatively in these settings. For beach or resort areas, don't forget your swimsuit, a cover-up, and flip-flops. A wide-brimmed hat, sunglasses, and sunscreen will also help protect you from the strong African sun.

Don't bring electrical appliances and gadgets. The electric outlets in Tanzania are 230 volts, while U.S. appliances are 110 volts. **This means you will not be able to use your U.S. small appliances and devices in Tanzania.** The exceptions are laptops, phone chargers and other such devices which are usually universal and should work in Tanzania. You might need an adapter for these devices, however, as the outlets in Tanzania are a different shape than those common in the U.S.

You can bring your own adapter or buy one when you arrive as adapters are very inexpensive in Benin and are readily available.

Toiletries/Personal Items

Be sure you bring all your toiletries and personal items. While you will have opportunities to buy such things in Tanzania, you might not be able to find the brands you prefer.

Customs Requirements

Passengers' obligations at Tanzanian Customs are outlined on the Tanzania Revenue Authority (TRA) website. For full details, please visit <https://www.tra.go.tz>.

When you arrive in Tanzania you will pass through Tanzania Customs, and you might be asked if you have anything to declare. You must declare any commercial goods or currency more than \$10,000 that you bring into Tanzania.

Money/Credit and Debit Cards/ATM's:

Cash

There is no limit on the amount of money you can bring into Tanzania. However, as stated above, if you bring in more than \$10,000 in cash, you must declare it when you pass through customs on entry. If you bring in less than \$10,000, there is no need to declare any cash that you bring in.

You will have several opportunities to change your dollars for the local currency during your stay in Tanzania. Please note that it is advisable that you bring any cash that you bring in either \$100 or \$50 bills as smaller denominations will be exchanged for a significantly lower exchange rate.

ATMs

There are ATMs in all the major cities you visit, but you will pay an international fee and a local bank fee for ATM transactions in addition to possibly receiving a lower exchange rate for each transaction.

Credit and Debit Cards

There will be several places where you can use your credit or debit card in Tanzania, particularly in major hotels, upscale restaurants, and larger shops or supermarkets in cities like Dar es Salaam, Arusha, and Zanzibar. However, Tanzania remains largely a cash-based economy, especially in rural areas, local markets, and smaller businesses. It's a good idea to carry enough Tanzanian shillings for everyday purchases and tipping. If you plan to use your debit or credit card while traveling, be sure to notify your bank in advance that you'll be in Tanzania to avoid any security holds or transaction blocks on your account.

Also, note, many of the businesses that take debit or credit cards use POS equipment which requires a pin number. While we all know our debit card pin number, most of us do not have or know a pin number for our credit cards. So, if you intend to use a credit card, contact your bank, and make sure you have and know the pin number associated with the card.

Note: the only credit cards accepted in Tanzania are Visa and Mastercard.

Food and Water

Your tour package includes breakfast daily and other specified meals (lunch/dinner), including a Welcome Dinner with Cultural Performances.

You will be able to buy meals that are not included in the tour package at restaurants that we have carefully selected. There will be a wide variety of food options available, giving you the chance to enjoy delicious Tanzanian cuisine, while also having access to more familiar international dishes. From flavorful rice and stew combinations to grilled meats, fresh seafood, and tropical fruits, there's something to suit every palate. The average cost of a meal with a soft drink and water in Tanzania ranges from \$10–\$20, depending on the location and type of restaurant.

Bottled water is readily available. However, the water in all of the hotels and restaurants that have been selected for you is potable and is safe for you to drink, use as ice cubes or to brush your teeth.

While some of your favorite snacks might be available in Tanzania, and we will make regular stops for you to stock up on snacks, fruit, and drinks during the trip, it is advisable for you to bring the special snacks that you prefer.

Hotels and Restaurants in Tanzania:

Hotels

You will be staying at hotels that have been carefully selected for you to ensure your comfort. These hotels are highly rated with clean comfortable rooms and well-trained staff. However, standards might vary from those to which you might be accustomed.

For example, while bath towels and hand towels are available and supplied at all the selected hotels, face cloths are not normally available. So, you should bring your own face cloth.

Rest assured; our ground staff will be available to address any issue that might arise.

Restaurants

We have carefully selected each of the restaurants you will visit on your tour. These restaurants are chosen for their quality, cleanliness, and welcoming atmosphere, offering you a chance to enjoy safe, wholesome meals throughout your stay. You'll have the option to try authentic Tanzanian dishes or choose from a variety of continental options that may be more familiar to your taste.

While the food is tasty, Tanzanian restaurants are known for slow service, so you might have to exercise a bit of patience before your meal arrives. Whenever possible, our staff will help you to place your order in advance of arrival at a restaurant, to cut down on the wait time.

Cell Phone/Data Usage and Internet Service:

Before your departure to Tanzania contact your mobile phone service provider and request international data service to access WhatsApp, or similar apps for internet-based communications. Such communications are significantly less costly than international roaming charges.

You could also ask for a one-month international voice package. While this could be costly, it is cheaper than the bill you will receive if you make calls without a call package.

If you make or receive international calls while you are in Tanzania and you do not have the appropriate international call/data packages, you will be shocked when you receive your telephone service billing statement.

Other information that might be helpful as you prepare for your trip:

Country Profile

Tanzania is located in East Africa, bordered by Kenya and Uganda to the north, Rwanda, Burundi, and the Democratic Republic of Congo to the west, Zambia, Malawi, and Mozambique to the south, and the Indian Ocean to the east. The country's diverse geography includes vast savannahs, the Great Rift Valley, highlands, coastal plains, and several lakes—including Lake Victoria, Africa's largest. It is also home to Mount Kilimanjaro, Africa's highest peak. Tanzania has a tropical climate, with variations depending on altitude. The coastal areas are hot and humid, while the highlands are cooler. The main rainy seasons are from March to May and a shorter one from October to December.

The capital city is Dodoma, where the government is based, but the largest and most economically significant city is Dar es Salaam, located on the coast. Other key cities include Arusha, Mwanza, and Zanzibar City. Tanzania has a population of over 65 million people, made up of more than 120 ethnic groups. The largest groups include the Sukuma, Chagga, Haya, and Nyamwezi. While Swahili is the national language and widely spoken, English is also used in government, business, and education. The majority of Tanzanians practice Christianity or Islam, with traditional beliefs still observed in some communities.

Tanzania has a rich and complex history. It was part of several powerful trading empires and coastal city-states that were integral to Indian Ocean trade networks. The region was later colonized by Germany and then Britain before gaining independence in 1961. Today, Tanzania is known for its political stability, stunning wildlife and national parks, cultural diversity, and warm, welcoming people.

Geography:

Tanzania, officially the United Republic of Tanzania, is located in East Africa and stretches from the Indian Ocean in the east to the Great Lakes region in the west. It shares borders with Kenya and Uganda to the north, Rwanda, Burundi, and the Democratic Republic of the Congo to the west, and Zambia, Malawi, and Mozambique to the south. Its eastern coastline provides access to international maritime trade routes through the major port city of Dar es Salaam.

Covering approximately 945,087 square kilometers (364,900 sq mi), Tanzania is one of the largest countries in Africa. It has a population of over 65 million people and is known for its rich cultural diversity, with more than 120 ethnic groups. Tanzania is a unitary presidential republic, formed in 1964 through the union of Tanganyika and the islands of Zanzibar. The country operates under a multi-party political system and has maintained relative peace and political stability since its formation—making it a key example of peaceful coexistence and national unity in the region.

Economy:

The economy of Tanzania is diverse and growing, with key sectors including agriculture, mining, tourism, manufacturing, and services. Agriculture remains the backbone of the economy, employing the majority of the population and contributing significantly to GDP. Major crops include maize, rice, coffee, tea, cashew nuts, and cloves—especially on the islands of Zanzibar and Pemba.

Tanzania is also rich in natural resources, with significant deposits of gold, diamonds, tanzanite (a gemstone found only in Tanzania), and natural gas. The mining sector has attracted substantial foreign investment in recent years. Tourism is another major economic driver, with Tanzania being home to world-renowned attractions such as Serengeti National Park, Mount Kilimanjaro, and the beaches of Zanzibar.

The country has made notable progress in infrastructure development, particularly in roads, energy, and port facilities, to support trade and economic growth. Dar es Salaam, the main commercial hub, serves as a crucial gateway for trade to and from several landlocked neighboring countries. In recent years, the government has emphasized industrialization, economic reform, and digital innovation as part of its development strategy, aiming to position Tanzania as a middle-income economy.

The Currency

The official currency of Tanzania is the Tanzanian Shilling, with the currency code TZS. It is commonly represented as "TSh" or simply "Sh". The Tanzanian Shilling is not pegged to any foreign currency and fluctuates based on market conditions, so exchange rates with the U.S. dollar may vary. When traveling to Tanzania, you can exchange U.S. dollars for Tanzanian Shillings at local banks, currency exchange offices, or even at the airport. It's advisable to carry some Tanzanian Shillings for smaller transactions, as not all establishments may accept U.S. dollars. Regarding bringing cash into the country, there is no limit on the amount of Tanzanian Shillings you can bring in. However, if you are carrying the equivalent of \$10,000 USD or more, you must declare it to customs upon arrival. Amounts below this threshold do not require a declaration.

Language:

The official language of Tanzania is Swahili (Kiswahili), which is widely spoken across the country and used in government, education, and business. Swahili serves as a unifying language, bridging the diverse ethnic groups in Tanzania. It is the primary language of communication for the majority of Tanzanians, and many people speak it fluently. In addition to Swahili, English is also an official language and is used in higher education, business, and government, though it is less commonly spoken in everyday life outside of urban centers. Tanzania is home to more than 120 ethnic groups, and as a result, there is a rich linguistic diversity in the country. Among the most widely spoken local languages are Sukuma, Chaga, Haya, and Nyamwezi, which are often used in regional areas. However, Swahili remains the dominant language for communication across the nation. In major cities like Dar es Salaam and tourist areas, you will generally find that many people, particularly in the service industry, speak basic English, making it relatively easy for visitors to communicate. However, knowing some Swahili phrases can be helpful and appreciated by locals.

Government:

Tanzania is a republic with a presidential system of government. The President of Tanzania serves as both the head of state and head of government, and is elected by popular vote for a five-year term, with the possibility of one re-election. Tanzania has a multi-party system, and its political landscape has evolved significantly since gaining independence from British rule in 1961. The country transitioned from a one-party system to a multi-party democracy in the early 1990s.

The Constitution of Tanzania, adopted in 1977, established a government based on three branches: the Executive, the Legislative, and the Judiciary. The president appoints ministers and oversees the execution of national policy, while the Parliament, composed of the National Assembly, serves as the legislative body. The judiciary is independent and ensures the application of the law.

Elections are held every five years, and Tanzania has generally been known for its peaceful elections and smooth transitions of power, though challenges related to political freedom and transparency have been raised in recent years.

Current President: Samia Suluhu Hassan

Vice President: Philip Mpango

History:

Before European colonization, Tanzania was home to a diverse array of ethnic groups and kingdoms, each with its own political and social systems. Among the most notable pre-colonial states were the Kingdom of Zanzibar, the Sultanate of Pate, and the kingdom of Buganda (in what is now Uganda, but historically had strong ties with the coastal areas). Zanzibar, in particular, was a key center of trade, with its economy based on spices, ivory, and slaves, and it had significant interactions with Arab traders for centuries.

The first Europeans to reach Tanzania were Portuguese explorers in the 16th century, but they had limited influence in the region. The Omani Arabs eventually took control of Zanzibar in the 17th century, and it became a prominent hub in the Indian Ocean trade network. In the late 19th century, the Germans colonized the mainland and established the colony of German East Africa, which included present-day Tanzania, Rwanda, and Burundi. The Germans faced resistance from local communities, including the Maji Maji Rebellion (1905-1907), but their rule ultimately persisted until the end of World War I.

After Germany's defeat in World War I, the League of Nations placed the territory under British mandate, and it became known as Tanganyika. Meanwhile, Zanzibar remained a British protectorate. Tanganyika gained independence from Britain on December 9, 1961, with Julius Nyerere becoming the first president. In 1964, Zanzibar merged with Tanganyika to form the United Republic of Tanzania. Nyerere's government embraced socialism and self-reliance under a policy called Ujamaa, though this economic model faced challenges. The country later transitioned to a multi-party democracy, and elections have been held regularly since the early 1990s. Despite challenges, Tanzania remains one of East Africa's most stable and influential countries. Tanzania's independence and its peaceful political evolution have positioned it as a respected member of the international community.

Climate:

Tanzania has a tropical climate that varies widely by region and elevation. Along the eastern coast and islands like Zanzibar, the weather is typically hot and humid year-round. In contrast, the central plateau regions are hot and semi-arid, while the highland areas in the north and south—such as those around Mount Kilimanjaro and the Southern Highlands—are cooler and experience

more rainfall. Average daily temperatures across the country hover around 77°F to 88°F (25°C to 31°C), with relatively small annual variations.

The coolest and driest part of the year falls between June and September, which is also Tanzania's main dry season. During this time, skies are typically clear, humidity is lower, and vegetation is lush, especially in the highlands and around national parks. In the northern and coastal regions, the rainy seasons occur from March to May (long rains) and again from October to December (short rains).

In August, Tanzania is well into its dry season. The weather is generally sunny and pleasant throughout most of the country. Coastal areas, including Dar es Salaam and Zanzibar, remain warm and humid, with average daytime temperatures ranging from 77°F to 86°F (25°C to 30°C). In contrast, the inland and highland regions are cooler, especially at night, with temperatures dropping to around 59°F (15°C). Rainfall is minimal across the country in August, making it an ideal time for travel and outdoor activities, especially safaris and mountain trekking.

Frequently Asked Questions

General Travel Information

1. Do I need a visa to visit Tanzania?

Yes, U.S. citizens need a visa to enter Tanzania. You can obtain an e-Visa online before arrival or get a visa on arrival at Tanzanian airport. Your passport must be valid for at least six months beyond your travel dates.

2. How can I apply for a visa?

You can apply for a visa online via the Tanzania e-Visa Portal or upon arrival at Tanzania Airport with entry visas cost of \$100. Check our website for the latest visa information and application links.

3. What vaccinations do I need before traveling?

A Yellow Fever vaccination is required for entry into Tanzania. Other recommended vaccines include Hepatitis A & B, typhoid, tetanus, and malaria prophylaxis.

4. Is Tanzania safe for tourists?

Tanzania is generally considered safe for travelers, especially in popular tourist areas such as Arusha, Zanzibar, and the national parks. However, as with any travel destination, it's important to stay alert and exercise common sense precautions. Petty crime, such as pickpocketing and bag snatching, can occur in crowded places like markets, bus stations, and city centers—particularly in Dar es Salaam and other major urban areas. Travelers are advised to avoid walking alone at night, especially in unfamiliar areas, and to limit how much cash and valuables they carry. Keep important documents like your passport secure, ideally in a hotel safe. When using transportation, opt for registered taxis or reputable ride-hailing services if available, and avoid using public transportation late at night. In rural and tourist areas, crime is less common, and locals are often welcoming and helpful. As always, staying aware of your surroundings, respecting local customs, and keeping up with local travel advisories will help ensure a safe and enjoyable experience in Tanzania.

5. What is the best time to visit Tanzania?

August is a great time to visit Tanzania, In August, offering generally sunny and pleasant weather throughout most of the country. Coastal areas, including Dar es Salaam and Zanzibar, remain warm and humid, with average daytime temperatures ranging from 77°F to 86°F (25°C to 30°C). In contrast, the inland and highland regions are cooler, especially at night, with temperatures dropping to around 59°F (15°C). Rainfall is minimal across the country in August, making it an ideal time for travel and outdoor activities, especially safaris and mountain trekking.

6. What is the dress code in Tanzania?

Bring comfortable, breathable clothing for your trip to Tanzania. Lightweight fabrics like cotton and linen are ideal for the warm, often humid climate, especially if you'll be spending time along the coast or in lowland areas. Pack a light sweater or jacket for the cooler highland mornings and evenings, particularly if you're visiting places like Arusha or the Ngorongoro Highlands.

7. Are public toilets available at tourist sites?

Public toilets are available at major tourist attractions, but they may not always be well-maintained. Carry tissues and hand sanitizer.

8. Is there internet access?

Hotels, cafes, and restaurants in major cities offer Wi-Fi. A local SIM card is recommended for better mobile internet access.

9. Is it allowed to take photographs of people?

Always ask for permission before photographing individuals, especially in rural areas and markets.

10. What fitness level is required for sightseeing?

A moderate fitness level is recommended, especially for excursions to natural sites and islands.

11. What kind of shoes should I wear?

Comfortable walking shoes or sandals are a must, especially if you plan to explore markets, towns, or take part in outdoor excursions.

12. How is the power supply in Tanzania?

The electric outlets in Tanzania supply 230 volts at a frequency of 50 Hz, which is higher than the 110 volts used in the United States. This means most U.S. appliances that are not dual voltage will not work in Tanzania without a voltage converter. However, many modern electronic devices such as laptops, phone chargers, and cameras are usually designed for dual voltage (100–240V) and should work fine—just check the label on your device to be sure. You will likely need a plug adapter, as Tanzania uses Type D and Type G plugs (the same as in the UK), which are different from the standard U.S. plug shape. It's a good idea to bring a universal adapter if you plan to use multiple devices during your stay.

13. Can I drink alcohol in Tanzania?

Yes, alcohol is widely available in hotels, restaurants, and bars throughout Tanzania. The country has a diverse cultural and religious makeup, including Christianity, Islam, and traditional beliefs, and in general, alcohol is socially accepted and accessible, especially in urban areas and tourist destinations like Dar es Salaam, Arusha, and Zanzibar.

However, in predominantly Muslim regions—particularly along the coast and in Zanzibar—alcohol availability may be more limited, and public consumption is often more discreet out of respect for local customs. While alcohol is still served in many hotels and resorts in these areas, it's important for visitors to be mindful and respectful of local

traditions. Drinking responsibly and observing cultural norms will help ensure a positive experience.

14. Is smoking allowed in Tanzania?

Smoking is allowed in outdoor areas but is restricted in enclosed public spaces.

15. What food options are available in Tanzania?

In hotels throughout Tanzania, a full buffet breakfast is typically provided each day, often including a mix of continental and local options. Tanzanian cuisine is rich, flavorful, and influenced by African, Arab, and Indian traditions. Traditional dishes often feature staples such as ugali (a stiff maize porridge), rice, chapati (flatbread), and plantains, usually served with savory stews, vegetables, or grilled meats.

Popular proteins include beef, chicken, goat, and fresh seafood, especially along the coast and on islands like Zanzibar. Dishes are often seasoned with a variety of spices, reflecting the country's coastal trade history. One well-known local favorite is nyama choma (grilled meat, usually goat or beef), commonly served with side dishes like kachumbari (a fresh tomato and onion salad).

Vegetarian options are widely available and often include beans, lentils, spinach, okra, and other local vegetables, often cooked in coconut milk or tomato-based sauces. Meals are frequently accompanied by fresh tropical fruits such as mangoes, pineapples, papayas, and bananas, along with fresh juices or spiced teas.

Money & Costs

16. What currency is used in Tanzania?

The official currency of Tanzania is the Tanzanian Shilling (TZS). Credit and debit cards are accepted in major hotels, upscale restaurants, and some larger shops—especially in cities like Dar es Salaam, Arusha, and tourist areas like Zanzibar. However, cash is widely preferred, particularly in local markets, small businesses, and rural areas where card payment facilities may not be available. It's a good idea to carry Tanzanian Shillings for everyday purchases, and ATMs are commonly found in urban centers for easy cash withdrawals.

17. How much does a meal cost in Tanzania?

A meal at a mid-range restaurant costs about \$15-\$25, while street food or casual dining can be around \$5-\$10.

18. Can I use U.S. dollars in Tanzania?

U.S. dollars are not widely accepted. It is best to exchange money at banks or Forex Bureaus.

Transportation & Getting Around

19. Do I need an international driver's license to rent a car?

Yes, an International Driving Permit (IDP) is required to rent a car. Traffic conditions can be hectic, so hiring a driver is recommended.

20. Is public transportation safe?

Public transportation, such as minibuses and shared taxis, can be crowded and confusing. Tourists are advised to use private taxis or ride-hailing services.

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21. Is tap water safe to drink?

We will supply you with bottled water each day. It is also available in your hotel rooms. Although the locals all drink tap water it is very heavily chlorinated and is fine for brushing teeth and bathing, but is not recommended for drinking. The hotels and the restaurants that we select for you, all use purified water to make their ice cubes. So you should feel free to add ice cubes to your drinks.

22. Do I need travel insurance?

Yes, travel insurance is highly recommended for medical emergencies, lost luggage, and trip cancellations.

However, our company offers optional travel insurance through Allianz Global, a leader in the travel insurance field. You can click the link below or visit our website, www.africanconnections-usa.com, to get a quote.

https://www.agentmaxonline.com/agentmaxweb/widgets/quotetool.html?widgetid=859099&ac_cam=F212819&code=ABIYU4TLWGBGTNHC6ZWLRSKAR65GB6C5JLBJOIXR7QY3M6I5HDDHZDIECAM4JHS6KBOBIU5FYWB3BAHKTFTOR572B73AM4ZH74ZMN4XVK3YLBWT3Z3F4X4R3Z53LEU4

23. Should I bring my own medicine?

Bring sufficient prescribed medication for your trip. Pharmacies are available, but specific medicines may not always be in stock.

Activities

24. Is there time for shopping?

Yes! Tanzania is known for its vibrant and bustling markets, where visitors can shop for a wide range of traditional crafts and locally made goods. You'll find beautifully patterned kitenge and kanga fabrics, hand-carved wooden sculptures, beaded jewelry, Tinga Tinga paintings, woven baskets, and spice blends, especially in Zanzibar. Markets like Kariakoo Market in Dar es Salaam, Mwenge Carvers Market, and Stone Town's Darajani Market are popular spots to explore. These markets offer an authentic glimpse into local life and are great places to practice your bargaining skills, interact with artisans, and take home unique souvenirs that reflect Tanzania's diverse cultural heritage.

25. Can I make personal purchases?

Yes, budget around \$8-\$25 per day for personal expenses like snacks, drinks, and souvenirs. Larger purchases can be made with credit cards in major stores.

Prepare to be Amazed!

Beneath the breathtaking beauty of modern Tanzania lies a land where ancient cultures, wild landscapes, and coastal traditions come together in perfect harmony. From the sweeping plains of the Serengeti to the spice-scented streets of Zanzibar, Tanzania is a land of wonder, wildlife, and rich heritage. Tanzania is unique and unforgettable! Have your cameras ready!

The African Connections Team is eagerly awaiting your arrival in Tanzania and is ready to assist you as you prepare for your unforgettable African adventure!

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